HOMEWARD

STELLAR CHALLENGE 2026

Sending money home is easy. Knowing what it builds is harder.

Stage-based construction funding, independent checks, and shared family approval for overseas Indians building or renovating a home — while keeping their chosen builder.

US$135.4B

India inward remittances, FY2024–25.
All purposes — not Homeward TAM. [2]

15.8%

Kerala 2023 remittance-use category: **renovation of houses/shops**.
Not exclusively new homes. [3]

THE GAP | A RECEIPT IS NOT PROGRESS

Family sponsors can confirm a transfer instantly, but may depend on scattered photos, calls and contractor assurances to judge the work. An **August 2026 Kerala consumer case** involved a US-resident owner: his brother said **₹34.52 lakh** was paid on a **₹37.25-lakh** contract; work remained unfinished and leaking, and an expert report supported the ruling. This is a case, not a population loss rate. [1]

THE HOMEWARD WORKFLOW

1. **AGREE**
   Family, builder and sponsors set milestones, budget, scope and named payees.
2. **FUND**
   Relatives contribute to stages; approved material advances can go to named suppliers.
3. **VERIFY**
   Builder submits evidence; an independent engineer checks the site. Parents can ask for a re-check.
4. **RELEASE / HOLD**
   Designed Stellar rules gate later-stage payments on approvals and log decisions. Disputes stay on hold.

WHO BENEFITS

Overseas sponsors: clarity on where funds stand. **Parents:** a meaningful way to question progress. **Builders:** clear expectations for payment.

ENTRY MARKET

Canada-to-Kerala diaspora families financing self-managed construction or renovations with relatives on-site. Bank-linked stage verification and independent NRI monitoring services already exist; Homeward is testing an accessible family-funded version. [4]

THE DIFFERENTIATION

Chosen-builder flexibility + multiple family funders + independent engineer checks + parent re-checks + conditional stage payments in one shared workflow. The parts are not new; the customer experience and control model are the hypothesis.

BUSINESS MODEL

The demo shows a **proposed 1.5% Homeward fee** supporting engineer review, whether work passes or fails. On a hypothetical **₹15-lakh** budget, that is **₹22,500 gross fees** if charged once on the full budget, before all operating, inspection, FX and payout costs. Price acceptance and margins are not validated.

PROTOTYPE AND PROOF

Screens show stage funding, **paid / locked / unfunded** balances, sample engineer checks, a Stellar Expert certificate link, and an unspent-funds return interface. **Testnet demonstration:** Interac, INR payout, engineer licences and sample images are simulated; production payout compliance and transaction-level release/refund proof remain to be established.

VALIDATION FOCUS

Test with diaspora funders, builders, independent inspectors and a qualified payout provider. Measure willingness to pay, blocked unapproved releases, inspection cost, and dispute resolution. **No adoption or loss-prevention rate is claimed.**

A home is built in stages. Confidence should be, too.

SOURCES: [1] Indian Express, 10 Aug 2026 (Wayanad case) [2] Ministry of Finance / PIB, 29 Jan 2026 [3] Kerala Migration Survey 2023, Table 5.11 [4] ICICI Home Finance; NRI Land Check.